
Request for Accommodation

Audio Recording of Medical Appointments

Where you stand, in the College's own words.

The College of Physicians and Surgeons of Alberta (CPSA), in its published advice to Albertans, states:

“Although you can record your conversation, you cannot record anyone else’s conversations (e.g., you can record in an exam room but not in the waiting room). However, you should let your physician know before recording them.”

The CPSA further warns that a physician who does not know of, or consent to, being recorded may regard it as a breach of trust, that clinics may have policies prohibiting recording without consent, and that such breaches **“could harm your relationship with them and result in you being discharged as a patient.”**

The CPSA's own direction to patients is this:

“Explain to your physician why you would like to record the appointment and request their consent before starting to record.”

That is what this form is for. It explains your reason, requests consent, and records the answer.

Section 1 - Patient

Patient name

Date of request

Physician name

Clinic name

Section 2 - Why I am asking

Tick all that apply. You do not have to disclose a diagnosis.

I have difficulty remembering what is said to me during appointments.

I have a cognitive condition that affects processing or recall.

Anxiety or stress in medical settings affects my ability to take in information.

I need extra time to process spoken information.

Pain, fatigue, or medication affects my concentration.

My care involves multiple providers and I need an accurate record to share with them.

I need to share instructions accurately with a support person or caregiver.

Other (described below).

In my own words, this is how it affects me in appointments:

Maximum 420 characters.

Section 3 - What I am asking for

Permission to make an **audio recording** of my appointment with you.

If recording is declined: a **written summary** of the plan and instructions before I leave.

If recording is declined: permission to bring a **support person** to take notes.

Time to **repeat back** instructions so we can confirm I have understood them.

Section 4 - My undertakings

If consent is given, I agree to the following:

I will record **only my own appointment**. I will not record in waiting rooms or record other patients or staff.

I will tell you each time before I begin recording.

I will stop recording immediately if you ask me to.

I will use the recording for **my own care only**. I will not post it publicly or share it online.

I may share it with a caregiver, support person, or another treating provider involved in my care.

Patient signature

Date

If printing this form, sign by hand.

Section 5 - For completion by the physician or clinic

Consent granted. The patient may record their appointments as set out above.

Consent granted with conditions (set out below).

Consent declined. Reason set out below.

Conditions, or reason for declining:

Maximum 340 characters.

If recording is declined, alternative accommodation offered:

Maximum 200 characters.

Physician signature

Date

How to use this form

1. Fill in Sections 1 to 4. Fill it in on screen, or print it and write on it.
2. Give it to the clinic ahead of your appointment, or bring it with you.
3. Ask them to complete Section 5, and **keep a signed copy for yourself.**
4. If consent is declined, that is their right. But you now have their reason in writing and an alternative accommodation on the record. Keep it.

Ask before you record. The CPSA is clear that recording without your physician's knowledge can result in you being discharged as a patient. Losing your doctor in the middle of a disability application is a cost none of us can afford. Ask, get the answer in writing, and you are protected either way.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown - Advocate

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This form is an advocacy tool and is not legal advice. Quoted passages are taken from the published advice of the College of Physicians and Surgeons of Alberta (CPSA) to Albertans, "Ending the Physician-Patient Relationship."